

The Agvet Chemicals Subcommittee (ACS) is the key senior executive forum for the stewardship of agvet chemicals policy. It is comprised of decision-makers from Australian, state and territory governments. The ACS provides a collaborative forum to drive a coordinated national approach towards consistency in agvet chemical control of use (CoU) functions.

Background

In February 2025, the ACS was established by the Agriculture Senior Officials' Committee (AGSOC) in response to the [Australian Government's Detailed Response to the Final Report on the Structure and Governance Arrangements of the APVMA](#).

Originally formed as a time-limited task group, the ACS was required to report back to AGSOC in early 2026. Its work confirmed that achieving greater national consistency across the agvet chemicals CoU legislative framework is feasible, warranted, and that there are practical pathways to reform.

In March 2026, AGSOC endorsed the continuation of the ACS with the purpose of driving a coordinated national approach towards improved consistency in agvet chemical CoU functions.

Looking ahead

In 2026, the ACS will move into a design phase including the identification and prioritisation of reform opportunities.

Delivering nationally consistent approaches will require sustained collaboration across jurisdictions and portfolios. The ACS has emphasised throughout its work the critical importance of stakeholder engagement in both the design and implementation of any future harmonisation measures. The subcommittee will look to engage with industry stakeholders and other interested parties as policy and regulatory proposals are developed.

Nationally consistent approach is intended to support improved safety outcomes in the use of agvet chemicals, while also delivering benefits for businesses, chemical users, and governments through greater clarity, efficiency, and alignment.

Contact

The Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry is providing secretariat support to the ACS and can be contacted by email ACS@aff.gov.au.

ACS membership is made of the below representatives.

Jurisdiction portfolio	Title
Australian government representation and Chair	Deputy Secretary, Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry Policy Group

Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry

New South Wales

Department of Primary Industries

Director, Food Safety & CEO, NSW Food Authority

South Australia

Department of Primary Industries and Regions

Executive Director Biosecurity

Northern Territory

Department of Agriculture and Fisheries

Chief Plant Health Officer

Queensland

Department of Agriculture and Fisheries

Deputy Director-General and Chief Biosecurity Officer

Tasmania

Department of Natural Resources and Environment

Manager, Product Integrity

Victoria

Department of Energy, Environment and Climate Action

Executive Director Animal Welfare and Agriculture Regulatory Policy

Western Australia

Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development

Director, Biosecurity Governance, Strategy and Performance

Australian Capital Territory

Environment, Planning and Sustainable Development Directorate

Senior Director, Environment Protection Policy, Environment, Water and Emissions Reduction

Observer

Australian Pesticides and Veterinary Medicines Authority

Chief Executive Officer

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/ag-vet-chemicals/domestic-policy/agvet-chemical-subcommittee>